



THE FUTURE IS GAMING

Despite all the flak it gets, the gaming industry is one of the most innovative industries out there; leaders when it comes to using new technologies and providing new, unique experiences. From the look of things, it's nowhere near stopping.

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There are few industries that push the boundaries of technology and innovation the way gaming does. Gaming is always at the forefront of new technologies, new experiences, new kinds of immersive entertainment, and even accessibility and inclusion of as many people as possible. Globally, the video game industry is a powerhouse, pulling in more revenue than every other entertainment industry combined. It has been doing so for a few years now. In 2019, Netflix CEO Reed Hastings told shareholders that their biggest competition wasn't other streaming platforms, but the game Fortnite. In the words of Matthew Ball, former head of strategy at Amazon Studios, "It used to be 'what to watch', now it's 'whether to watch,'" and seemingly, the latter wins out a lot more. So how did we get to the point where the League of Legends World Championship has more viewership than the Super Bowl? Not that the Super Bowl really concerns us, but it's still a pretty significant number. To get a better understanding, let's take a look at the rapid growth of the video game industry over the past 20 years.

THE MODERN AGE OF GAMING

After the golden age of arcade games, the advent of home gaming on con-

soles, and the rise of personal computers, at the turn of the millennium the internet would come around. This would herald the start of the modern age of gaming. This was a time when computer processor technology was improving at crazy fast rates. Furthermore, the cost of new tech, servers, and even the internet was starting to drop, making it easier for more and more people to access them. Every new generation of games blew the previous generation out of the park. The Internet played a major role in bringing gaming to the masses and would also go on to become a key aspect of gaming in itself, with online multiplayer becoming an integral

part of gaming by the time the Xbox 360 came around in 2005.

Online integration is a given in just about every game today, if not in the form of a multiplayer online mode, in some other form, such as achievement sharing for single-player experiences. Online only games, where the experience is solely competitive and social, are not only common, but also among the most popular kinds of games on the planet, averaging millions of active players every month. These include competitive First Person Shooter (FPS) games like Counter-Strike, Multiplayer Online Battle Arenas (MOBAs) like League of Legends and Massively



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